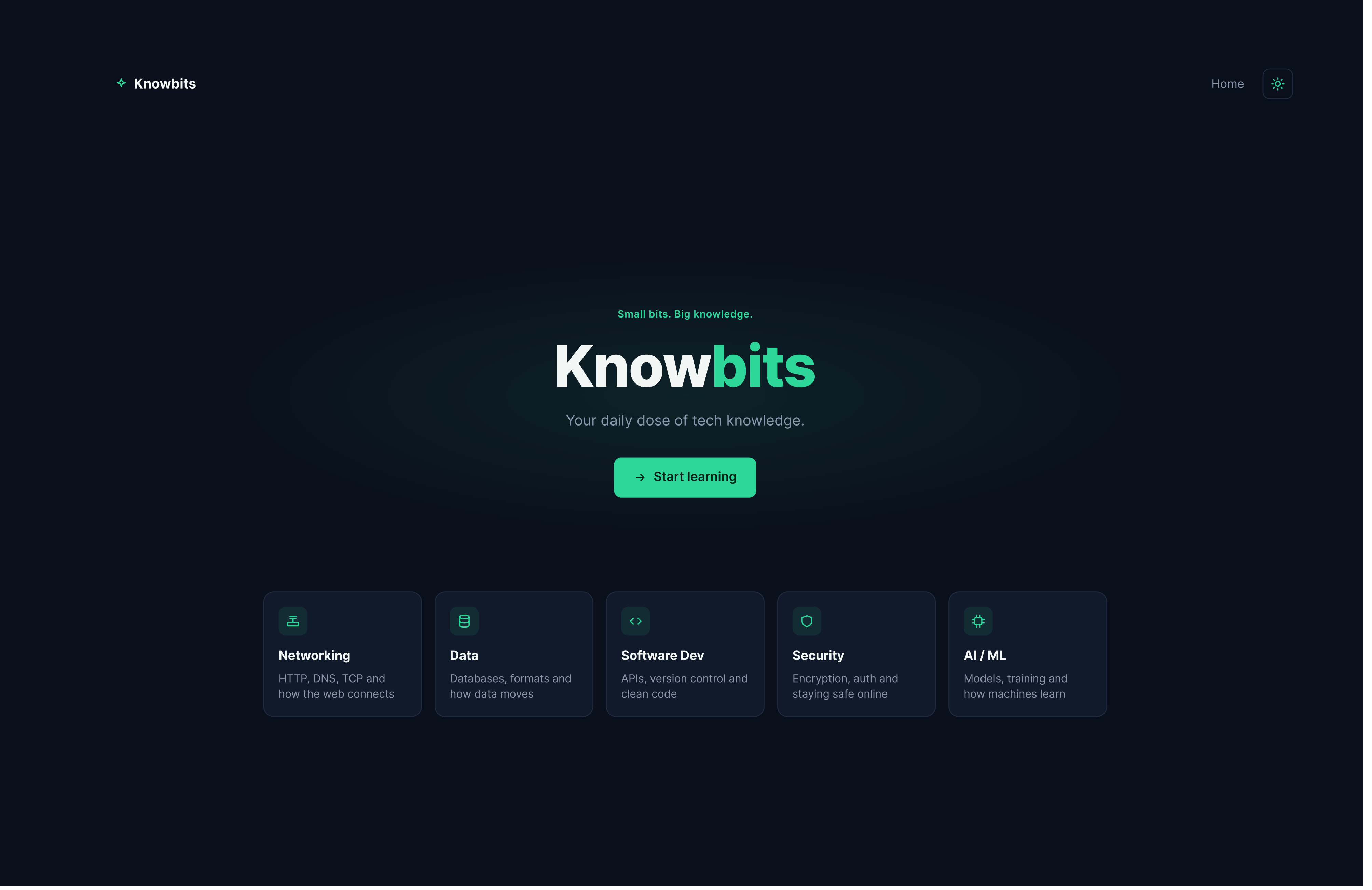
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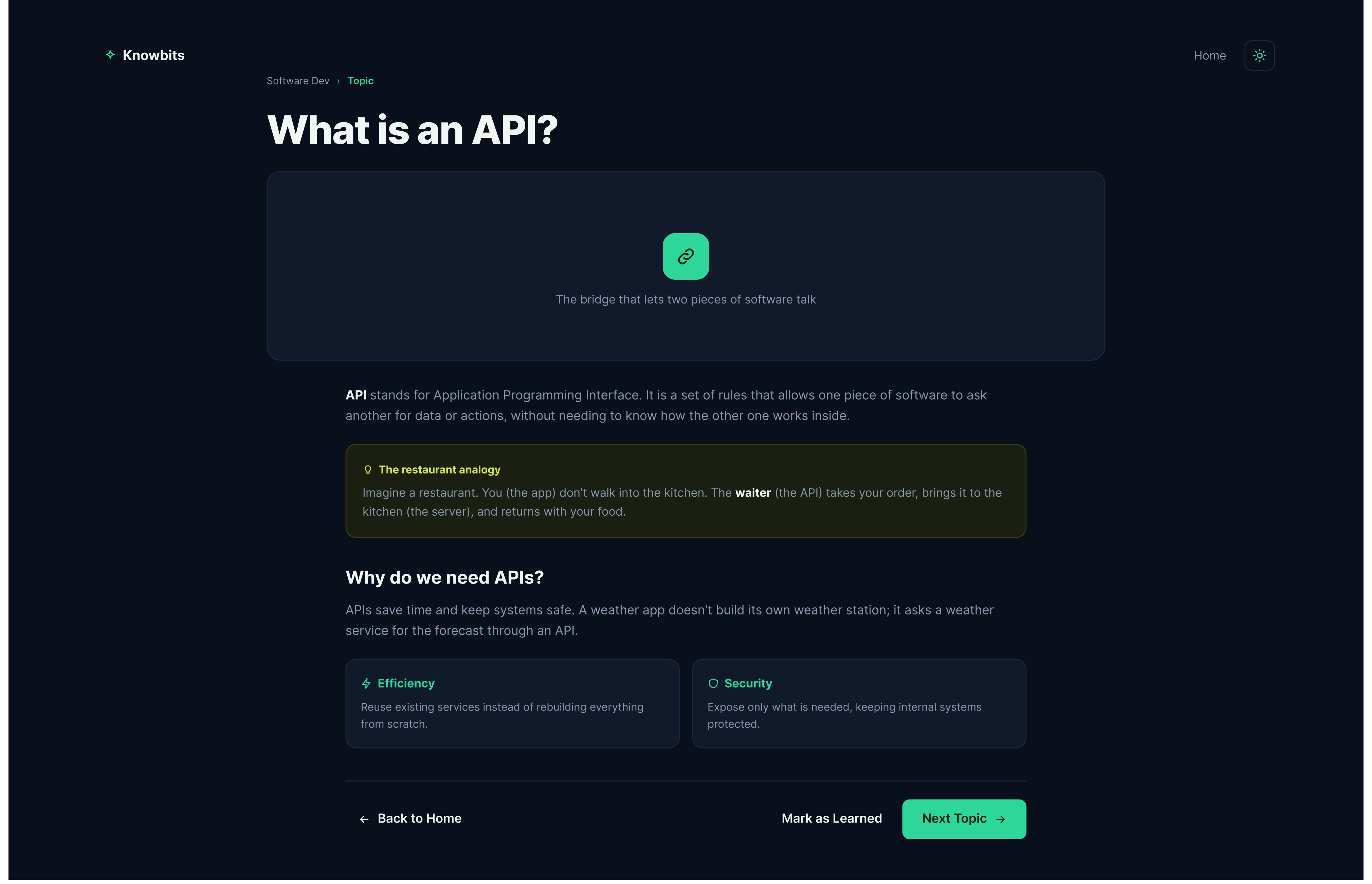
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Software Dev › Topic

What is an API?

The bridge that lets two pieces of software talk

API stands for Application Programming Interface. It is a set of rules that allows one piece of software to ask another for data or actions, without needing to know how the other one works inside.

The restaurant analogy
Imagine a restaurant. You (the app) don't walk into the kitchen. The **waiter** (the API) takes your order, brings it to the kitchen (the server), and returns with your food.

Why do we need APIs?

APIs save time and keep systems safe. A weather app doesn't build its own weather station; it asks a weather service for the forecast through an API.

Efficiency
Reuse existing services instead of rebuilding everything from scratch.

Security
Expose only what is needed, keeping internal systems protected.

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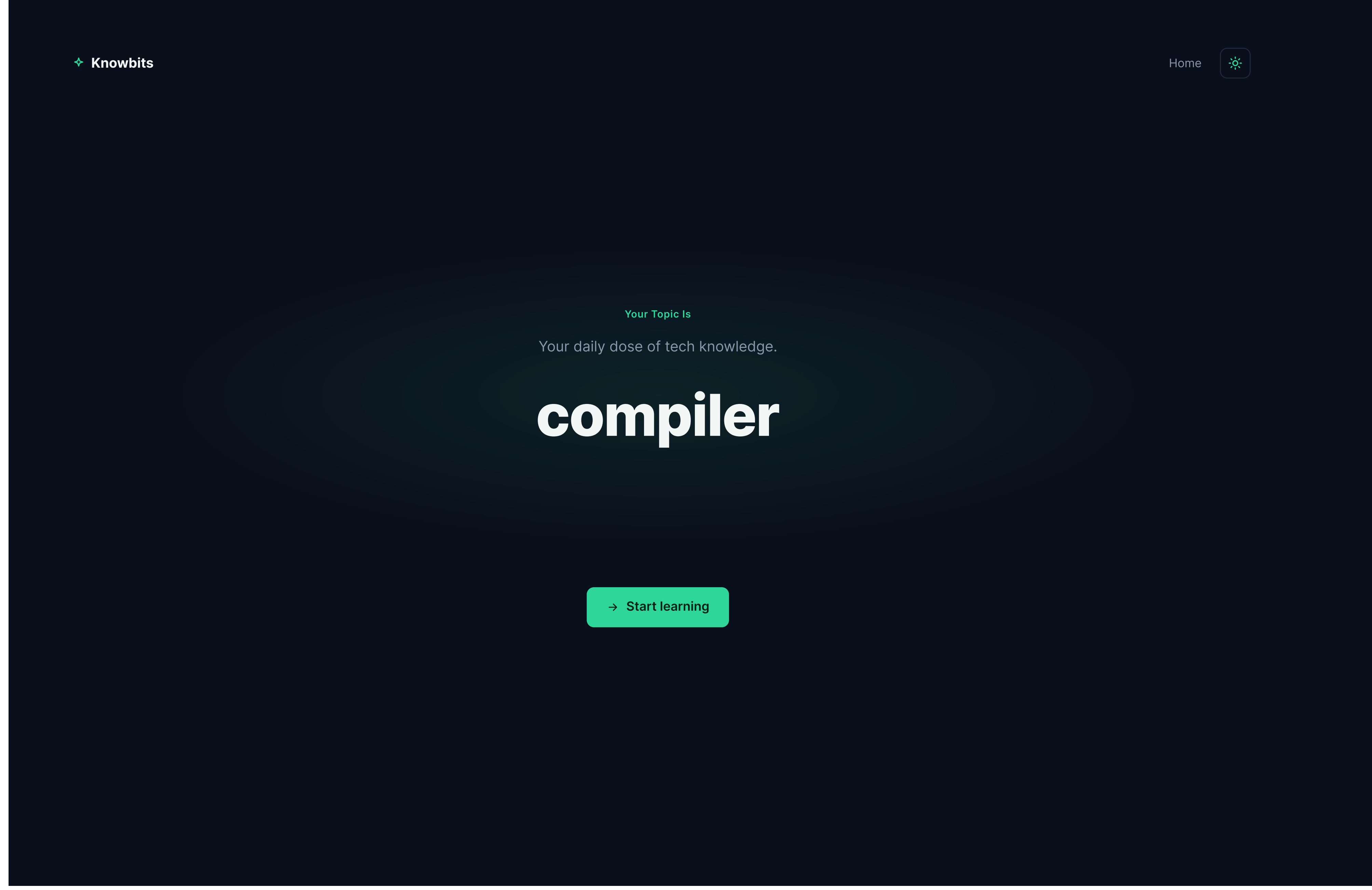
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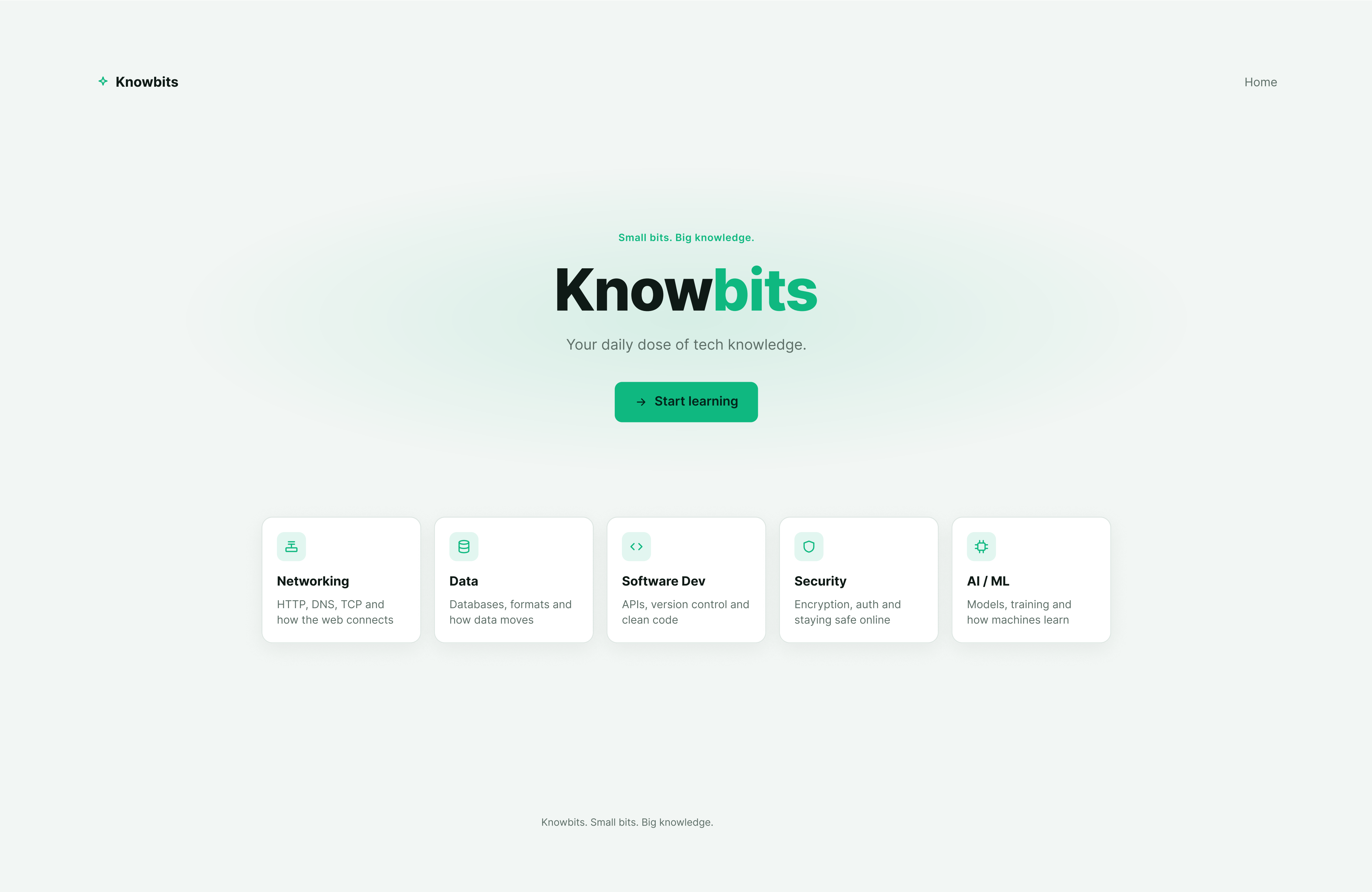
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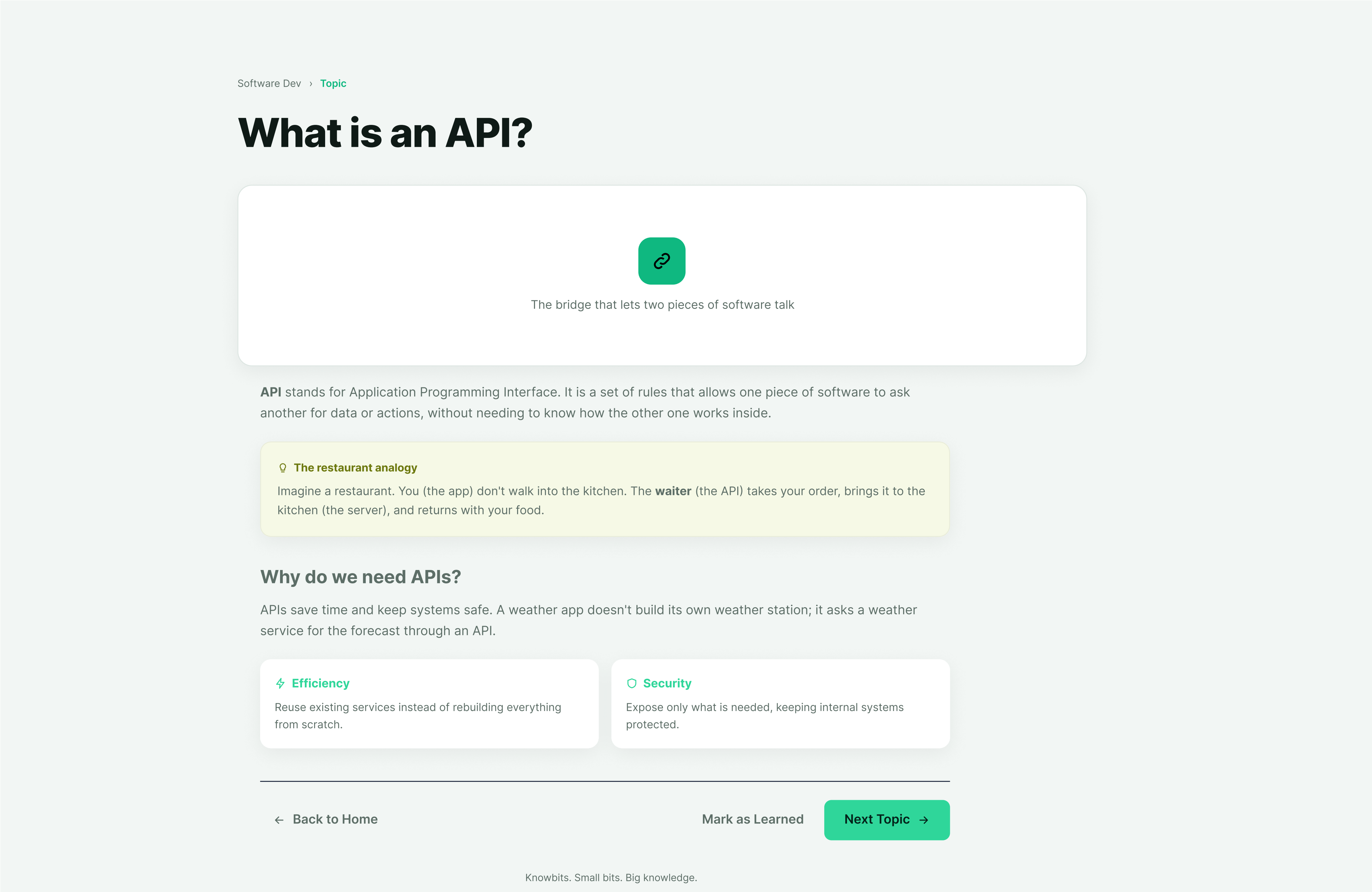
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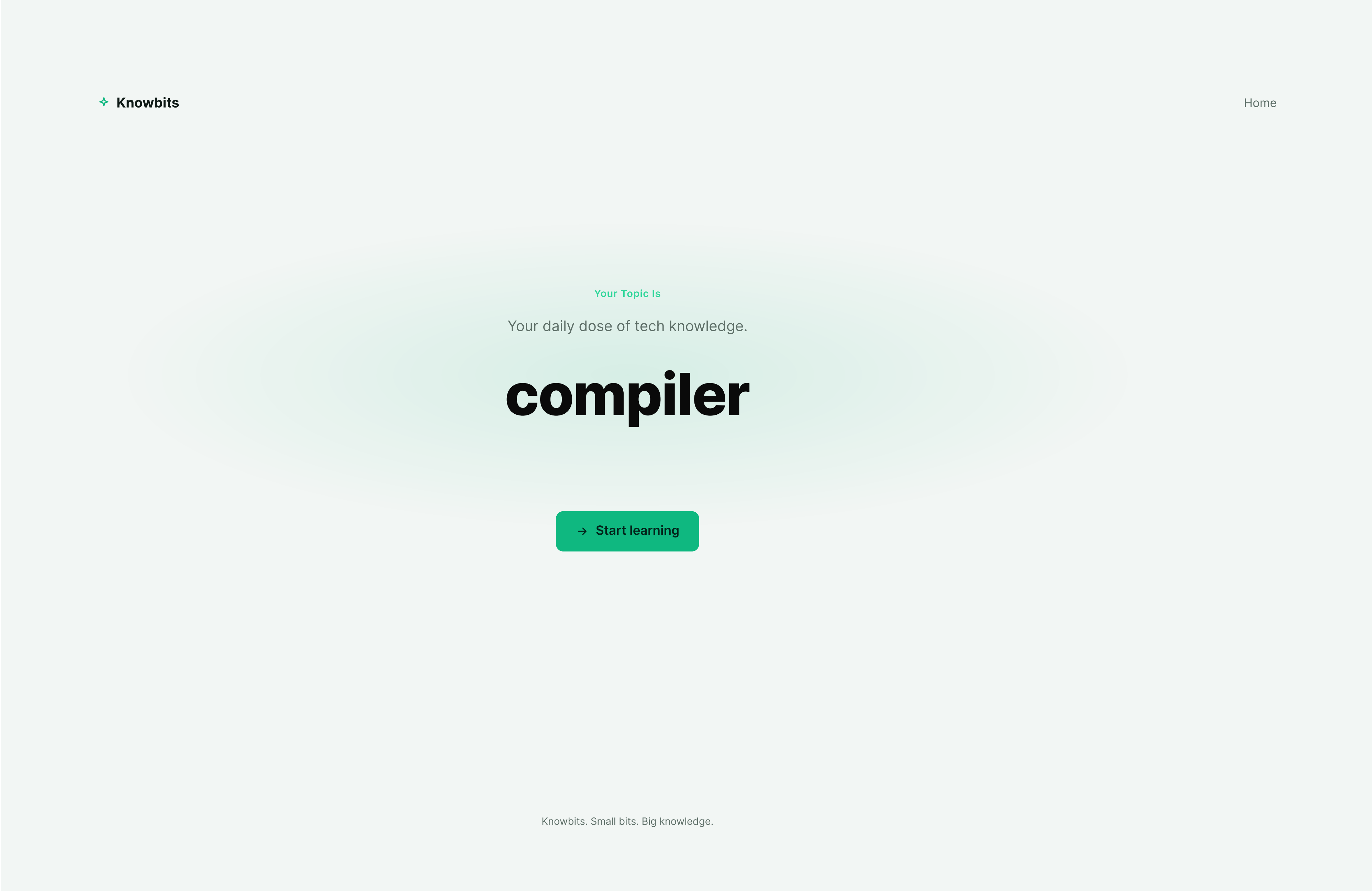
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